Passage-5

In India, agriculture still engages about half of its workforce, and about 85 percent of its farms are small and marginal. Compared to China and Vietnam, which have experienced fast structural and rural transformation, India's story is of slow transformation. As a result, poverty reduction in India was at a much slower pace during 1988-2014, compared to China and Vietnam. India's poverty reduction was slow during 1988-2005, but during 2005-2012, it accelerated dramatically–almost three times faster than during the earlier period. What did India do during this period? Research reveals that the relative price scenario changed significantly (by more than 50%) in favour of agriculture in the wake of rising global prices. This boosted private investments in agriculture by more than 50%. As a result, agri-GDP growth touched 4.1% during 2007-2012 as against 2.4% during 2002-2007. The net surplus of agri-trade touched $25 billion in 2013-14; real farm wages rose by 7% per annum. All this led to unprecedented fall in poverty.

6. With reference to the above passage, the following assumptions have been made :

1. **Structural and rural transformation is impossible when farms are mainly small and marginal.**
2. **A good price incentive can trigger investments in agriculture.**
3. **India needs to build value chains for high value agri-products like livestock and horticulture.**
4. **Higher global prices of agricultural commodities are essential for India's poverty reduction.**

Which of the above assumptions are valid?

(a) 1 and 3 (b) 2 and 4
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 3 and 4

Ans. (c) : In the above passage the logical and practical implication is that the remunerative price of the crops attracts more investment in incentives agricultural products. India needs to build value chains for high value agriproducts like livestock and horticulture.
Hence, option (c) is correct answer.

7. Which one of the following statements best reflects the critical message of the passage?

(a) India should create large-scale off-farm rural employment to reduce poverty in the near future.
(b) India should create a large number of farmer producer companies.
(c) Private investment in agriculture should be given priority over public investment.
(d) Inclusive agricultural growth is key to reduce poverty in the near future.

Ans. (d) : The best transmission of the critical message of the passage is that the development of inclusive and sustainable agriculture can play an important role in poverty alleviation in the near future. Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

Directions for the following 6 (six) items :

Read the following five passages and answer the items that follow. Your answers to these items should be based on the passage only.

Passage–1

In India, over the last decade or so, labour has been departing agriculture, but is only going to construction and unregistered manufacturing which are not marketly better jobs. Services, where labour tends to be most productive, are not generating the additional jobs the country needs. India will need 24 million or so jobs over the next decade. The new sector, e-commerce, can at best close only half the jobs gap. Only those sectors that drive domestic demand such as health and education can comfortably fill the other half.

8. Which one of the following is best implied in the passage?

(a) Strong measure need to be taken to reduce the rural to urban migration of labour.
(b) The working condition in construction and unregistered manufacturing needs to be improved.
(c) Service sector has been reducing the problem of unemployment.
(d) Increased social sector spending is imperative for large-scale job creation.

Ans. (d) : The most important implication of the given passage is that there is a need to increase the expenditure of the social sector to stop the migration of workers from rural to urban areas and to generate employment on a local scale. One such scheme is the Atmanirbhar Bharat campaign, the ambitions plan of the government of India during the recent Covid-19 global disaster.

Passage-2

In India, the current focus on the right to privacy is based on some new realities of the digital age. A right is a substantive righty only if it works in all situations, and for everyone. A right to free expression for an individual about her exploitation, for instance, is meaningless without actual availability of security that guarantees that private force cannot be used to thwart this right. The role of the State, therefore, is not just to abstain from preventing rightful free expression, but also to actively ensure that private parties are not able to block it.

9. On the basis of the above passage, the following assumptions have been made :

1. **State should have some institutions to ensure its appropriate role in a digital society.**
2. **State should ensure that private parties do not violate the citizens' rights to privacy.**
3. **Digital economy is not compatible with the idea of not violating the citizen's privacy.**

Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 2 only

Ans. (a) : The presumption made by the passage shows that, to ensure its role and importance in the technological (digital) Society, the state has to establish same public institutions, at the same time the state must also ensure that any, even private parties could not infringe on the right to privacy of citizens. Hence, both the assumptions (1) & (2) are valid.

Passage-3

One of the biggest ironies around water is that it comes from rivers and other wetlands. Yet it is seem as divorced from them. White water is used as a resource, public policy does not always grasp that it a is a part of the natural ecosystem. Efforts at engineering water systems are thus efforts at augmenting water supply rather than strengthening the capacities of ecological systems

10. Which one of the following is the most logical and rational inference that can be made from the above passage?

(a) Rivers and other wetlands should be protected under Ramsar Convention.
(b) Engineering water systems should be modernized and further augmented.
(c) Wetlands need to be reinforced as more than just open sources of water.
(d) Water supply should not be free of cost so as to prevent its misuse or overuse.

Ans. (c) : Option (a) is incorrect as the statement relating to Ramsar convention is not implicit in the passage. Option (b) is incorrect as the option given in the passage suggest the contrary. Option (c) is correct because the passage states that "It is ironic that water comes from rivers and wetlands, yet water is considered separate from them." Therefore, they should be reinforced more, although option (d) is correct from its statement but it is not mentioned in the passage. Hence option (c) is the most appropriate.

Passage–4

Asset allocation is the most important investment decision we will ever make, and sadly, most of us do not give that decision the importance it deserves. We are adamant about seeking predictability with our future. We tend to think of investing in risky assets as extremely volatile and value croding. we also dislike fluctuating returns and the loss of control of investment. We think our money is best left idle, unproductive but safe. There is no asset that is risk-free. We could lose our jobs, our homes can lose value, our banks can go bankrupt, our bonds can default, the government can collapse and companies we chose fondly may cease to exist. But we cannot live life assuming that all these extreme events are waiting to happen, and all at the same time. All these extreme forms of risks we know will not manifest at the same time.

11. Which one of the following statements best implies the suggestion given by the author of the passage?

(a) Distribute your wealth across different kinds of assets so that your risks would be minimized.
(b) Risk-taking behavior should be a necessary component of your personality if you want to generate wealth.
(c) While making investments, find a trustworthy asset management organization which would manage your wealth for you.
(d) You should know that investing your money is a risky business.

Ans. (a) : In the given passage, the author has given utmost importance on the fact that it would be best to keep money and property by investing in different types of assets, because by doing so the risk and loss will be minimized. Hence, option (a) indicates the best advice of the author.

Passage–5

Although most of the Genetically Modified (GM) crops cultivated now are genetically engineered for a single trait, in future, crops genetically engineered for more than one trait will be the norm. thus, biotechnology's role in agriculture and the regulation of the same cannot be understood solely in the context of the current generation of GM crops. Instead, there is a need to take a comprehensive look, taking into account various aspects, including socio-economic impacts, so that the potential of the technology can be harnessed while minimizing negative impacts. Given the importance of biotechnology in developing varieties that can help in climate change mitigation and adaptation, not using biotechnology as a part of the climate change action plan cannot be an option. Domestic regulation of biotechnology cannot be viewed in isolation of trade policy and obligations under various international treaties and conventions.